

Quiet surface, traceable depth.

An Apple-minimal interface for a document intelligence product — where the one memorable idea is that every extracted fact and every answer traces back to its source.

Signature — “every fact traces home.” Citations illuminate the exact source region on hover; extracted data is shown in a monospace face so the structure pulled from your documents is legible in the type itself. Boldness lives here; everything else stays calm.

01 Design thesis

Minimal directions live or die on precision, not features. The job here is restraint executed exactly: generous space, true hierarchy, one accent, calm motion — and a single signature interaction that belongs only to this product.

Principles

- **Content is the interface.** Chrome recedes; the document, the answer, and the evidence are the focus.
- **One accent, used sparingly.** Iris blue marks action and selection — nothing else competes for attention.
- **Data looks like data.** Amounts, IDs, dates, and facts are set in mono — the subject's own material made visible.
- **Motion clarifies.** Every animation explains a state change; none decorates.

What it is not

- No gradients-as-personality, no neon accent on near-black, no broadsheet hairline pastiche.
- No decorative iconography or stock illustration.
- No more than three font weights or two type families.
- Nothing that reads as a template the product didn't earn.

02 Color — light

A cool graphite neutral ramp on warm-white paper, with one iris-blue accent. Neutrals carry the whole interface; the accent appears only on action, selection, and links.

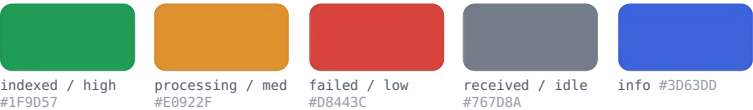
Accent — Iris (the one bold place)



Neutral — Graphite



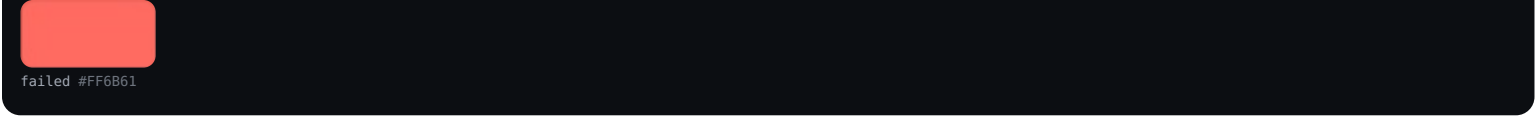
Status & confidence



03 Color — dark

Not pure black. A blue-graphite canvas with elevated surfaces lifted by lightness and a hairline border rather than heavy shadow. The accent brightens for contrast.





Contrast floor: body text meets WCAG AA ($\geq 4.5:1$) in both themes; secondary text and disabled states meet $\geq 3:1$. The accent is never the only signal — it pairs with text or icon so color is never load-bearing alone.

04 Typography

Two families, three weights. **SF Pro** (system) with **Inter** as the web fallback for all UI and prose; **SF Mono** / **Geist Mono** for extracted data, identifiers, counts, and trace output. The mono face is the signature: structure looks structured.

Documents, understood.

Display · 34/41 · 600 · -0.02em — page titles, hero

Your archive, answered

Title1 · 28/34 · 600 — section heads

Invoice — ACME Corp, March 2025

Title3 · 18/24 · 600 — card titles

Every answer cites the documents it used, so you can verify the source in one click.

Body · 15/23 · 400 — primary reading text

invoice_total = 1,240.00 USD · due 2025-04-01

Mono-data · 13/18 · 450 — facts, IDs, amounts, dates (signature)

INDEXED · 18 FACTS · 4 PAGES

Caption · 11/14 · 500 · 0.01em — meta, badges

05 Space, radius, elevation

Spacing — 4pt grid

2 · 4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 20 · 24 · 32 · 40 · 48 · 64 · 80

Layouts breathe: 24–32 between sections, 16 inside cards, 8 between related controls. Whitespace is the primary structuring device.

Radius

sm 8 · md 12 (cards) · lg 16 (modals) · xl 22 (sheets) · pill 999

Elevation

- e1 card rest — 0 1px 2px rgba(20,23,28,.06)
- e2 menu/hover — 0 4px 12px rgba(20,23,28,.08)
- e3 modal — 0 16px 48px rgba(20,23,28,.16)

In dark mode, lift comes from surface lightness + hairline border; shadow is reserved for modals only. Depth is suggested, never heavy.

06 Motion

Calm, quick, spring-eased. Motion exists to make a state change legible. Everything honors `prefers-reduced-motion` by falling back to opacity-only.

Token	Value	Used for
ease-quiet	cubic-bezier(.32,.72,0,1)	the default — panels, routes, sheets (Apple spring-out feel)
ease-standard	cubic-bezier(.4,0,.2,1)	hovers, small state changes
dur-micro	160ms	hover, press (button/card press scales to .98)
dur-base	220ms	route change: fade + 8px rise
dur-emphasis	320ms	modal: scale .97→1 + fade
dur-sheet	420ms	side panel / bottom sheet slide-in

Three motions carry the product. (1) **Pipeline fill** — upload cards advance received → OCR → extracting → indexed as stage pips fill, with a 1.2s pulse while active. (2) **Trace reveal** — retrieval steps stream in 120ms apart, like an agent thinking aloud. (3) **Citation glow** — hovering a citation tints the source region (160ms); clicking smooth-scrolls and pulses the highlight (600ms). These three are the felt identity.

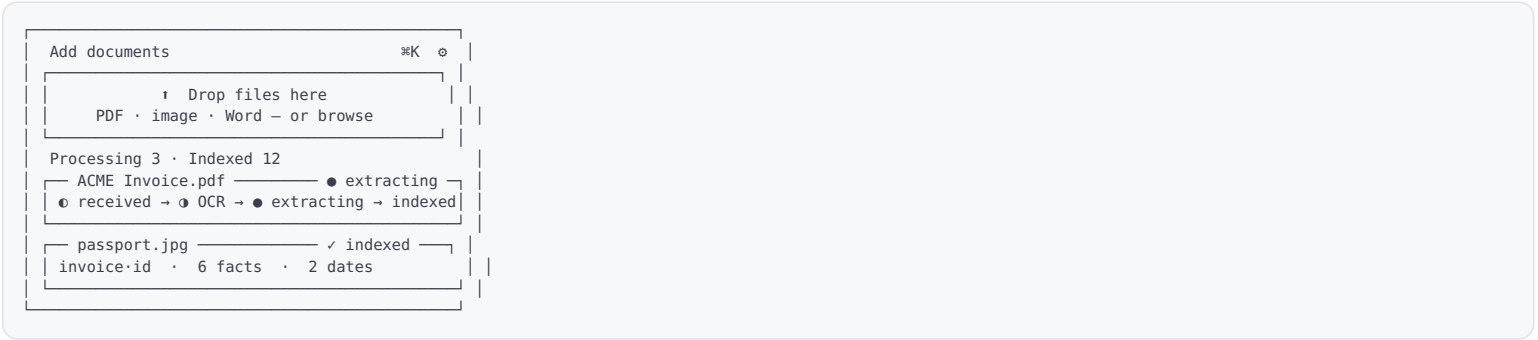
07 Component inventory

Group	Components
Actions	Button (primary / secondary / ghost / destructive), icon button, segmented control, ⌘K command palette
Inputs	Text field, search, dropzone, select / combobox, toggle, slider, chip input (for classes)
Containers	Card, document card, side panel, modal, bottom sheet, tabs, accordion (trace), table
Signals	Status badge, confidence bar, class chip, citation pill, toast, tooltip, skeleton, empty state
Navigation	Sidebar, top bar, breadcrumb, account switcher (personal ≠ company)
Data	Stat tile, line / area / bar chart, sparkline, usage meter, pricing card

Built on accessible primitives (Radix), styled entirely from the tokens above. No component invents a color, radius, or duration outside the system.

08 Screen — Upload

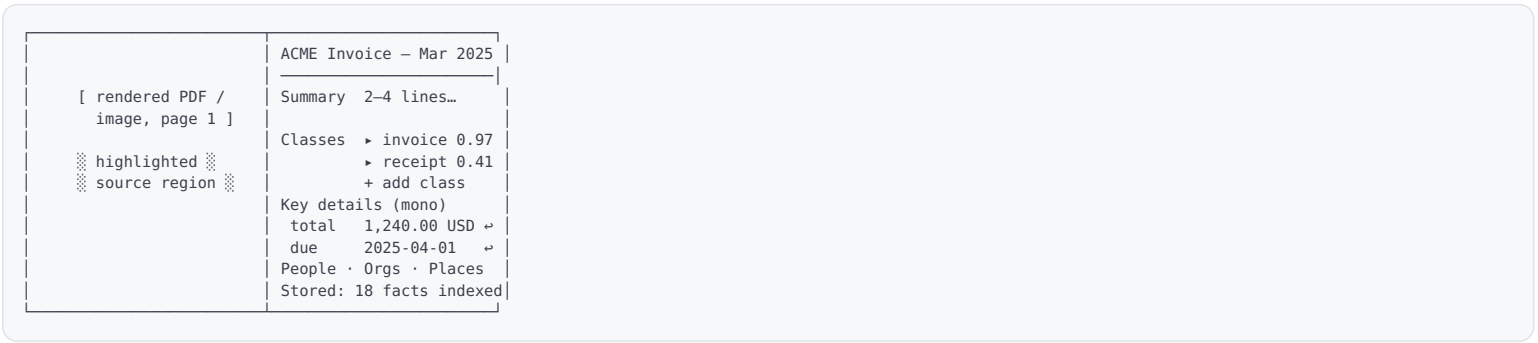
One dropzone, any file. Dropping immediately renders a card in *received* state that animates through the pipeline — the user's “glimpse” of how a document becomes structured data, shown as honest progress, not a spinner.



- **Optimistic + honest:** the card appears instantly; stage pips reflect real backend status (`received` → `ocr_done` → `extracted` → `indexed`).
- **Forgiving ingest:** drag-drop, browse, paste, and multi-file all land in the same flow. Duplicates are recognized, not re-uploaded.
- **Copy from the user's side:** “Drop files here,” “12 indexed,” never “run extraction pipeline.”

09 Screen — Document view

Source on the left, understanding on the right. This is where provenance lives: each extracted fact links to the exact spot it came from.



- **Provenance (signature):** the `↔` on any fact jumps to and pulses its source region. Hover previews the highlight without leaving the panel.
- **Classification, legible:** multi-label chips with a quiet confidence bar; an empty set is a valid, calm state, not an error.
- **User-defined classes:** defaults are seeded; “+ add class” lets a user name and apply their own, reused across the archive.
- **The glimpse, not the guts:** “18 facts indexed” conveys that the doc is searchable — without exposing embeddings or vectors.

10 Screen — Ask (retrieval transparency)

A conversational surface in the GPT/Claude idiom: the answer streams, and an expandable trace shows what was searched and retrieved — visible by default for trust, collapsible for calm.

How much did I spend on medical in 2024?

▶ Worked through your documents

· matched 3 invoices, 1 statement

· summed typed amounts (not guessed)

You spent 4,180.00 USD across 4 documents.

① ACME clinic

② LabCorp

③ ... (click to open)

Was this helpful?

^ good

∨ off

★ rate

Scope:

● whole archive

○ this document

- **Tools, shown:** the trace names what happened in plain language — searched metadata, retrieved N facts from M docs, summed typed values. It reveals step-by-step (120ms stagger).
- **Citations are first-class:** numbered, inline, click-to-source. Numeric answers come from typed facts, and the trace says so — earning the user's trust in the number.
- **Honesty path:** when evidence is thin, the answer says the documents don't contain it rather than inventing one.

11 Screen — Ratings & feedback

Lightweight by default, specific on demand. A thumb is one tap; a low rating opens precise reasons that map to real failure modes and feed the eval harness.

good ^ / off ∨ ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆ (optional)

└ if off →

☐ not grounded

☐ missing a document

☐ wrong number

☐ wrong document

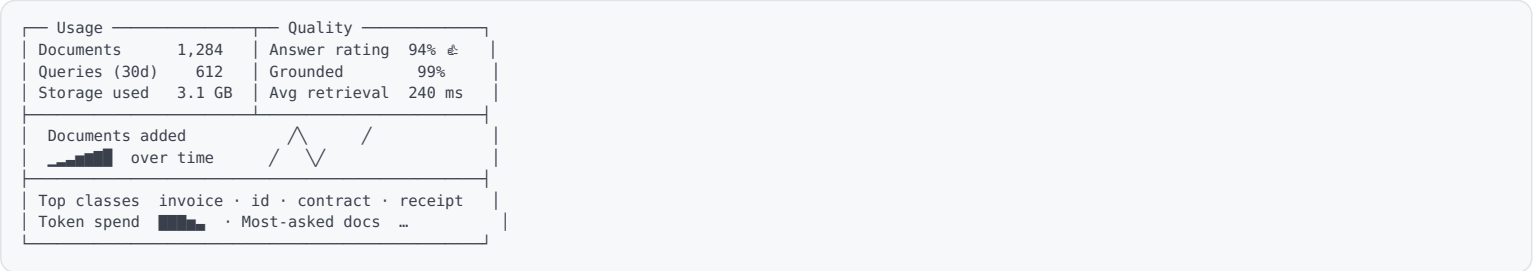
"add a note..."

Send

- **Closes the loop:** ratings attach to the answer's `retrieval_traces` row, turning real usage into eval signal and a quality metric on the analytics page.
- **Reasons are diagnostic:** the chips mirror the system's weak spots (grounding, recall, numeric, ranking) so feedback is actionable, not vague.

12 Screen — Analytics

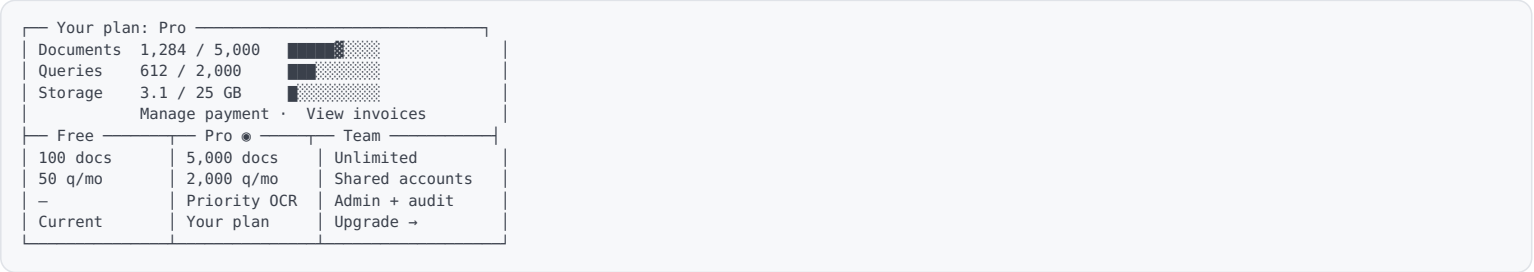
Calm dashboards over the data the system already records. Charts are sparse and labeled, in neutral ink with a single accent series — no chart-junk.



- **Derived, not bolted on:** documents over time, queries/day, storage, retrieval latency, token spend, extraction success, and answer quality all come from `processing_events`, `retrieval_traces`, and usage events.
- **Two lenses:** Usage (what you're storing and asking) and Quality (how well it's answering) — the second is what makes this more than a vanity page.

13 Screen — Billing & plans

Plan state and usage-against-quota up top; a restrained pricing table below. Meters use the status palette so “near limit” reads instantly.



- **Tiers map to real cost drivers:** documents, queries, and storage — the things that actually consume OCR, LLM, and disk — so pricing is legible and honest.
- **Quota is a first-class signal:** meters turn amber then red approaching a limit; the upgrade path is one calm step, never a nag.
- **Company accounts** unlock shared access and the audit trail — the natural Team-tier line.

14 Quality floor & anti-template checklist

Non-negotiable floor

- Responsive to mobile; touch targets ≥ 44px.
- Visible keyboard focus on every control.
- `prefers-reduced-motion` respected everywhere.
- AA contrast; color never the only signal.
- Real empty, loading, and error states — each a direction to act, not a mood.

“Not vibe-coded” test

- Every color, radius, and duration comes from a token — none invented inline.
- One accent, two type families, three weights — held to.
- Boldness spent only on provenance + trace + data-as-mono.
- Copy is active voice, sentence case, user-side vocabulary.
- Remove one accessory before shipping each screen.

15 Recommended stack

Next.js + TypeScript, Tailwind driven entirely by the token set (CSS variables for light/dark), **Radix UI** for accessible primitives, **Framer Motion** for the three signature motions, **Recharts/Visx** for analytics, **TanStack Query** for server state. Fonts via `next/font` (Inter + Geist Mono; SF Pro/SF Mono when on Apple platforms). Tokens are the contract between this document and the code — see `FRONTEND.md` for the machine-readable values.